Lesson 07: Listening: Immigrants; Grammar: Verbs, Simple Sentences, Imperatives

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

Adapted from People and Places - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0): 1.4: Videos: The Contributions of Immigrants; 1.5: Grammar: What is a Verb?; 1.6: Grammar: Simple Sentences; 1.7: Grammar: Imperative Mood.

In this lesson

You will watch a video about immigrants in San Francisco's Mission District and a news report about Iraqi Chaldean immigrants in El Cajon, California. Then you will study verbs, simple sentence patterns and the imperative.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Find the genre, purpose and details of a short video.
- Use words like culture, immigrant and integration to talk about immigrants.
- Find the verb in a sentence and use the auxiliaries do, be and have.
- Find the subject, verb and predicate of a simple sentence.
- Use the imperative for requests, instructions and orders.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
immigrant	a person who comes to live permanently in a foreign country	Some students at this college are immigrants.
culture / cultural	the way of life of a group: art, music, religion, language, food, tradition	Immigrants contribute many cultural benefits to our community.
integration	when two cultures mix in a society and both have equal value	Does this video show the integration of Chaldean Iraqis in El Cajon?
Hispanic	coming from a Spanish-speaking country	What cultural contributions do Hispanic immigrants make?
auxiliary	a helping verb: be, do, have (and modals)	Did you visit the art museum?
predicate	the part of the sentence with the verb	We live in El Cajon. (predicate: live in El Cajon)
linking verb	a verb (be, seem) that can be followed by an adjective	The weather today seems dry.

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
imperative	the base form of a verb, used without a subject	Don't forget your umbrella!

Rules and explanations

What is a verb?

- The verb is the center of an English sentence; every sentence needs one. A sentence can be just a verb: Study! Eat! Help!
- "Action" is not the test: tornado and wave (nouns) and windy (adjective) show activity but are not verbs; think and understand are verbs but not activities.
- A verb shows **tense** (time): flew (past), flies (present), will fly (future).
- A verb shows **aspect**: simple (flew, flies), continuous (is flying, was flying), perfect (has flown, had flown).
- Test: can the word show past tense (-ed or a new form)? show → showed, think → thought. Then it is a verb.

Auxiliaries: be, do, have (plus modals)

- **do / does / did** makes questions and negatives in the simple present and past: Do you want a souvenir? I did not visit the art museum.
- **be (am, is, are, was, were) + -ing** makes the continuous: Are they flying a kite? We were sunbathing at the beach.
- **have / has / had + past participle** makes the perfect: That family has immigrated to El Cajon. We had already seen the zoo.
- The continuous always uses "be". An -ing word **without** "be" is often a gerund (a noun): "activities like hiking, camping, and mountain-biking". (Your printed text says "with"; the book's slides correctly say "without".)

Simple sentences

- A **clause** is a group of words with a subject and a verb. A simple sentence has one clause.
- The **predicate** is the part with the verb: San Diego (subject) + has warm weather (predicate).
- Action verbs: jump, read, talk, ask. Stative (non-action) verbs: understand, like, be, seem.
- **Linking verbs** (be, seem) can be followed by an adjective. Other verbs cannot: NOT "He owned nice." NOT "She believed wonderful."
- The subject can be "it" or "there": It seems cold today. There are 26 students in this class.

Simple sentences use four patterns:

1. Subject + verb + noun phrase or prepositional phrase: San Diego has warm weather. We live in San Diego County.
2. Subject + linking verb + adjective: The weather today seems dry.

3. Subject + be + noun phrase: Some students at this college are immigrants.
4. Subject + be + prepositional phrase: Grossmont College is in El Cajon.

The imperative

- Form: base form of the verb + (complement). The subject "you" is understood but not written: Open the door!
- Negative: Do not (Don't) + base form: Don't forget your umbrella!
- Use it for requests (Sit down, please.), instructions (Read the first part of the chapter.) and orders (Leave now!).

> **Note for Arabic speakers**
>
> - In Arabic, a present-tense sentence often has no verb ("the weather cool"). English always needs a verb: The weather today **is** cool and breezy.
> - Arabic makes negatives and questions without a helper like "do". English uses do, does or did: I **do not** want a souvenir (not "I not want"). **Do** you want a souvenir?

Practice

1. Before you watch. Tell your tutor: What do you know about San Francisco? When immigrants move to a city, what benefits do they bring? Think about your own city.

2. Watch the Mission District video once (see "Watch online"). Answer the "Main Idea and Genre Comprehension" questions in your lesson material (section 1.4):

- a) the genre (what kind of video it is); b) the audience; c) the purpose; d) what helped you decide (topics, images, narration, length); e) where the latest immigrants are from; f) the cultural contributions of Hispanic immigrants (only those mentioned or shown); g) what Mission Dolores is.

3. Watch again.

- a) The Mission Dolores was built in the year ..... .
- b) Before the Hispanic immigrants, ..., ... and ..... people immigrated to the area.
- c) Which words did you hear? cultural, immigrants, griefs, joys, integration, Hispanic, public

4. Vocabulary. In your lesson material (section 1.4), do "Use the words above to fill in the blanks" with the seven words in 3c. The definitions are at the end of the section.

5. The El Cajon news report (see "Watch online").

- a) Before you watch, look at the photos in "Baghdad on the Border". What parts of their cultural identity have Chaldean Iraqis brought to their new home? Make a list.
- b) Where is the report published? What is the name of the website?
- c) What is its purpose? Choose one of the four answers in section 1.4.
- d) Does the video show the integration of Chaldean Iraqis in El Cajon? What parts help you decide?

6. Verbs. Which words can show past tense (add -ed or change form)? tornado, windy, think, understand, show, laugh, wave, fly

7. Find the verb in the five sentences under "Now you try..." in section 1.5.

8. Label the subject and verb in the five sentences under "Subjects and Verbs" in section 1.6.

9. Sentence parts. Do "Practice What You Learned" in section 1.6 (ten sentences, from "Grossmont College is a community college" to "It seems hot today"). Label the subject, verb or linking verb, noun phrase, adjective, prepositional phrase and any adverbs. For another explanation, watch the simple sentences video (see "Watch online").

10. The imperative. In your lesson material (section 1.7), read the paragraph from "Email Etiquette" and find the verbs in the imperative mood. For more, watch the imperative video (see "Watch online").

11. Your sentences. Write five simple sentences about a place you know well. Label the parts of each sentence.

Speak with your tutor

- "Ask me five questions about the Mission District video. Then let me retell it in five sentences. Correct my verbs."
- "Ask me: What parts of my culture did I bring to my new home, or what would I bring if I moved to another country? Will I continue to practice them?"
- "Role-play: I am a new student. Give me directions around the college with imperatives. Then I will give you five tips for writing a good email."

Read aloud

1. IM·mi·grant
2. CUL·tur·al
3. in·te·GRA·tion
4. his·PAN·ic
5. PRED·i·cate
6. im·PER·a·tive
7. Do you want a souvenir? (↗)
8. Did you visit the art museum? (↗)
9. Have you visited downtown San Diego? (↗)
10. Don't forget your umbrella! (↘)

Watch online

- National Geographic, "Mission District": https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l2HN7P9Y7aE
- VOA News report on Iraqi Christians in El Cajon (new address of the book's link): https://www.voanews.com/a/thousands-of-iraqi-christians-make-el-cajon-california-home/4641066.html

- "Baghdad on the Border" photos (archived copy; the book's link is dead): https://web.archive.org/web/20201006081809/https://www.curbed.com/a/texas-california/san-diego-immigration-iraqi-california
- Simple sentences (English with Jennifer): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pNm5kAXX4wQ
- The imperative mood (Englishing): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PIUW24UvQDY

Answer key

1. (example answer) San Francisco is a big city in California. Immigrants bring new food, music, languages and businesses.
2. a) An educational video about the contributions of immigrants to the Mission District. b) (example answer) Any adult interested in CA history; tourists. c) (example answer) To explain what is special about the Mission District; to show that immigrants help improve a neighborhood. d) The topics, images and narration. e) Mexico, and Central and South America. f) Art (on the walls), music, food, religion (the church). g) A church.
3. a) 1776 (the video says Spanish missionaries built it in 1776). b) Irish, German, Italian. c) All seven words.
4. immigrants, Hispanic, cultural, griefs, joys, public, integration (in this order).
5. a) (example answer) religion (a Chaldean church), the Arabic language, food (Iraqi bread), art, businesses. b) VOA News (Voice of America), voanews.com. c) (example answer) To explain what is special about Chaldean immigrants. d) Answers will vary. Look for scenes where the old culture and the new home come together.
6. think → thought, understand → understood, show → showed, laugh → laughed, fly → flew. No change: tornado (noun), windy (adjective), wave (noun) (book). Note: "wave" can also be a verb (wave your hand → waved), but here it means a wave in the sea.
7. a) is b) offers c) went d) contribute e) has (book)
8. a) San Diego / has b) We / live c) The weather / seems d) Grossmont College / is e) Some students at this college / are (book)
9. (book, completed) Subject / verb / other parts ("be" is a linking verb):
    - a) Grossmont College / is (be) / NP: a community college
    - b) It / is (be) / PP: on Grossmont College Drive, in El Cajon
    - c) El Cajon / is (be) / PP: in East County
    - d) Most Grossmont students / travel / PP: to the college, by car
    - e) El Cajon / has / NP: many attractive features
    - f) There / are (be) / NP: libraries, parks, and schools
    - g) Approximately 100,000 people / live / adverbs: approximately, here ("here" tells where: an adverb, not a noun phrase as the printed key says)
    - h) The climate / is (be) / adjective: Mediterranean
    - i) The weather / is (be) / adverb: usually; adjective: warm and dry
    - j) It / seems (linking verb) / adjective: hot; adverb: today
10. Eight: do not use; use; check; be (very clear); do not write; be (clear and concise); say; make (sure). ("Help!" is also an imperative, but there it is the example of a bad subject line.)
11. (example answer) My city has many old buildings. (S + V + NP) My family lives near the market. (S + V + PP) The streets are busy. (S + LV + adjective) My neighbors are teachers. (S + be + NP) The

market is in the city center. (S + be + PP)

My notes